

RAGING SWAN PRESS

CAMPAIGN BACKDROP: WOLFSBANE HOLLOW



5E



YOUR TIME IS PRECIOUS

MAKE YOUR CAMPAIGN PREP. EASIER

JOIN RAGING SWAN PRESS'S PATREON CAMPAIGN

[PATREON.COM/RAGINGSWANPRESS](https://patreon.com/ragingswanpress)

CAMPAIGN BACKDROP: WOLFSBANE HOLLOW

Shielded to the north by the Vurdfell Spine's lofty peaks and protected from the Hordelands of the east by the Greatshadow Gorge, the town of Wolfsbane Hollow has persisted in relative isolation for hundreds of years. Seemingly a simple border town, a dark shadow hangs over this hard, rough settlement. For here, the rule of law is tenuous at best, and the mayor is but a figurehead. The true power of Wolfsbane Hollow is the shadowy thieves' guild and their monstrous, bestial guildmaster who lurks in his lair carved from the fallen, mouldering bones of an ancient empire.

Campaign Backdrops give you, the busy GM, a carefully crafted mini-campaign settings ready to insert into your home campaign. This GM-friendly book presents beautiful hand-drawn maps, detailed settlements of note, a flavoursome regional gazetteer, random weather tables, exciting adventure hooks and more.

CREDITS

Design: Robert Brookes

Additional Design: Creighton Broadhurst

Development: Creighton Broadhurst

Art: Rick Hershey, William McAusland and Dean Spencer. Some artwork copyright William McAusland, used with permission. Publisher's Choice Quality Stock Art © Rick Hershey/Fat Goblin Games

Cartography: Tommi Salama

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any form or by any means, without the prior permission in writing of Raging Swan Press or as expressly permitted by law.

©Raging Swan Press 2020.

To contact us, email gatekeeper@ragingswan.com

To learn more about Raging Swan Press, visit ragingswan.com

To learn more about Raging Swan Press on Patreon, visit patreon.com/ragingswanpress



CONTENTS

Credits	1	Town Lore	20
Contents	2	Daily Life	20
Foreword	3	Trade & Industry.....	20
In Your Campaign	3	Law & Order	20
Patreon	3	Festivals & Traditions.....	20
Thank You!	3	Notable Locations	21
What has Gone Before	4	Notable Folk.....	22
Regional Gazetteer	6	Minor Events.....	22
Wolfsbane Hinterlands.....	6	Whispers & Rumours.....	24
Ashenblade Forest	6	Sights & Sounds	25
Drunau Forest.....	6	Notable Locations.....	26
Dankwood	6	1: Alethia's Home.....	26
Great Arvollan Forest.....	6	2: Argent Gardens.....	26
Greatshadow Gorge.....	7	3: Bits & Pieces.....	26
Vurdfell Spine.....	7	4: Broslef Estates.....	26
Weather in Wolfsbane Hollow	8	5: Church of Aether.....	26
Winter.....	8	6: Coldwater Mill	26
Spring.....	8	7: Horde Gate	26
Summer.....	8	8: House of Dust.....	27
Autumn	9	9: Lonehammer Mining Company	27
Weather Duration	9	10: Lonely Road Livery.....	27
Wind Direction	9	11: Netter's Shack.....	27
Wind Speed.....	9	12: Rostar's Forge.....	27
Religion in Wolfsbane Hollow	10	13: Ruined Cathedral	28
Aether, the Balance	10	14: Rustford Farms	28
Ignis, the First Spark	10	15: Sunspear Armoury	28
Mari, the Deep	10	16: Tamm Manor.....	28
Terra, the Maker	11	17: The Foxhound.....	28
Ventus, the Destroyer.....	11	18: The Pick and Pyrite.....	28
Adventure Hooks	12	19: The Serpent's Path	29
Hjalward at a Glance.....	14	20: The Underhollow	29
Village Lore.....	14	21: Vurdfell Gate.....	29
Villagers	14	22: Wayward Enterprises.....	29
Whispers & Rumours.....	14	23: Wayward Gate	30
Notable Locations	15	24: Winterbrook Orphanage	30
Notable Folk.....	15	25: Wolfsbane Cemetery.....	30
Notable Locations.....	16	26: Wolfsbane Garrison	30
1: Rurig's Mill	16	NPC Codex	31
2: Sorting Yard	16	Avud Kreslik	31
3: The Blackened Bucket.....	16	Dannor Claig.....	31
4: Sundered Emporium.....	16	Minor Wizard.....	32
5: Shrine of Aether.....	16	Tolun Moralli.....	32
6: Bael's Expeditions.....	16	OGL V1.0A.....	33
7: The Augan.....	17		
8: Caravan Grounds	17		
9: Hammersfall Mine	17		
Life in Hjalward.....	18		
Trade & Industry.....	18		
Law & Order.....	18		
Customs & Traditions	18		
Village Dressing.....	18		
Wolfsbane Hollow at a Glance	20		
Inhabitants.....	20		

FOREWORD

Long-time followers of Raging Swan Press may remember *Village Backdrop: Hjalward* and *Town Backdrop: Wolfsbane Hollow*. I've always wanted to bring the two together and to flesh out the surrounding territory. You hold the result in your hands, and I hope you enjoy it. This Campaign Backdrop is specifically designed to fit into the mountainous border regions in your campaign world. If you are planning an "Against the Giants" style game Wolfsbane Hollow is the perfect place to set it!

IN YOUR CAMPAIGN

Wolfsbane Hollow is easily inserted into almost any GM's campaign. Although, the history of Wolfsbane Hollow mentions the ancient empire (and city state) of Aevollis, such details are easily ignored, or modified to apply to a similar elder nation in your own campaign world. Similarly, the ancient frost giant empire of Isgiltur is likely so old and beyond the ken of normal folk that it should have no real effect on your campaign world.

Remember, references to the various deities worshipped in the town can be put down to minor regional powers or modified as necessary to better suit your game.

Finally, you can ignore the gazetteer information and simply place Wolfsbane Hollow and the village of Hjalward on the cusp of any mountainous region in your campaign. If it do this, you can simply rule the massive tower around which Hjalward has sprung up is an isolated hold of some long-dead frost giant chieftain.

PATREON

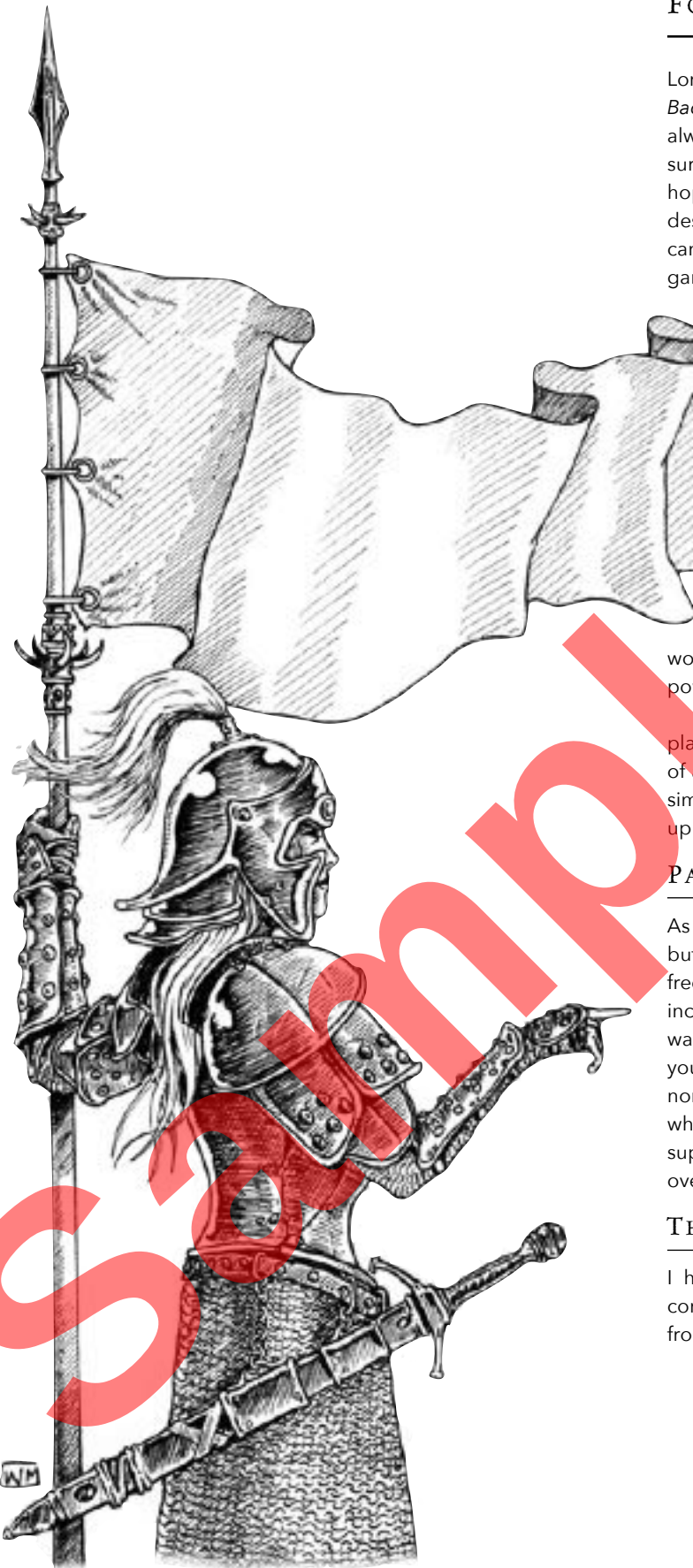
As I'm sure you know, the economics of 3PP are notoriously tight, but Patreon gives us at Raging Swan Press a way to increase our freelancer rates. At time of writing, we've already massively increased our word rate to 11 cents a word, which gives me a warm, fuzzy feeling. We want to pay more, but to do that we need your help! If you sign up, you get our supplements earlier than normal and cheaper than normal. Even better, you can pledge what you want and cancel when you want. If you are interested in supporting us, check out patreon.com/ragingswanpress or head over to patreon.com and search for Raging Swan!

THANK YOU!

I hope you enjoy this Campaign Backdrop. If you've got any comments or questions about Raging Swan Press, I'd love to hear from you. You can contact me at creighton@ragingswan.com.

Good luck with your game,

Creighton



WHAT HAS GONE BEFORE

Four hundred and sixty-three years ago when the people of Arvallis—then a vast kingdom—began eastward expansion, the foothills of the Vurdfell Spine were little more than frontier land rife with ruins of a long-fallen empire of giants. The first explorers who came to the region discovered a pristine woodland with a remarkable abundance of the highly poisonous aconitum, also known as wolfsbane. The explorers, seeking a route to the east, found little else in this remote part of the world and their eastward journey ended at Greatshadow Gorge. The settlers who would come in the wake of these Arvullan explorers built their new lives at the fork of three mighty rivers fed by runoff from the Vurdfell Spine. This small frontier settlement grew into a prosperous lumber camp over the course of a decade and soon was joined by two other settlements. These small communities, dependent on the forestry trade, grew together until their borders could no longer be defined. What remained came to be known, simply, as Wolfsbane Hollow.

As decades passed, Wolfsbane Hollow steadily grew in prosperity. The discovery of iron, copper and tin in the foothills brought wealth and renown to the frontier town and attention from the western lords of Arvallis. Soon the wealthy settlement was visited by the royal Arvullan military and, as luck would have it, royal Arvullan tax-collectors. The years that followed were at once prosperous and strained, as gold lined the pockets of wealthy mine owners and the Arvullan military established an informal control of the town's council. Serving the people in name only, the Wolfsbane Hollow council were puppets to the influential soldiers stationed at the garrison. But, when tensions between the free-spirited settlers and the military were at their worst, a pyrrhic victory was near at hand.

On a foggy autumn morning seventy-three years ago, a courier from the Arvullan capital arrived in Wolfsbane Hollow bound for the garrison. Within the day the entire compliment of city watch and military leadership stationed in the town for over fifteen years pulled up stakes and departed; war had come to Arvallis. It would be weeks more until Wolfsbane Hollow discovered the true scope of the situation, that the eastern expansion of the Kingdom of Arvallis had breached an unknown border: the Hordelands. While orcs were always common in the land, none knew for certain where their seat of power lay—or even if such a thing existed. The hordeland had been discovered, and taking the Arvullan incursion as an affront to their sovereignty, the tribes of the Hordelands united to wage war. Geographically isolated, Wolfsbane Hollow saw little of the terrible war that ravaged Arvallis for two and a half decades. Wounded survivors of great battles would find their way to the town, then deserters, then eventually nothing.

The years immediately following the war's conclusion left Wolfsbane Hollow isolated. Trade never fully recovered and many of the nearest cities to the west lay in ruin. Able to weather the storm with little conflict, the people of Wolfsbane Hollow were still impacted by their isolation and forced to struggle through several harsh winters with only themselves to rely on. The largely disliked

town council positions were dissolved during this time in favour of a strong singular leader in the form of a mayor. In the first few years after the war, many folk held the position as honeyed words and empty promises failed to placate strained and pragmatic citizens. Ultimately this weak leadership allowed a shadow growing beneath Wolfsbane Hollow to rise in power; a thieves' guild formed largely of army deserters, brigands and escaped criminals. While the thieves' guild struggled for years to get purchase on the town's leadership, all this was set to change with the coming of the town's darkest time.

The rapid deforestation of the Wolfsbane Hollow region eventually drew the attention of a pack of werewolves from the nearby mountains, who infiltrated Wolfsbane Hollow and turned the town into their personal hunting ground. These brazen attacks and fear of a lycanthropic outbreak stirred clerics from the church of Ignis—the Arvullan goddess of fire and healing—to action. It was thirty years ago when the clerics formed an inquisition in alliance with the townsfolk to hunt down the werewolves. For months the werewolves fought a losing battle with the inquisition. The inquisition's victory would have been absolute were it not for one of the inquisitors drawn from the townsfolk, Avud Kreslik. Avud suffered an injury during one of the inquisition's hunts from a werewolf that infected him with lycanthropy. Fearful of his fate should his injury be discovered, and foolishly arrogant of his own ability to control himself, Avud undid the entire inquisition.

When the crusaders had cornered the last of the werewolves in his lair in the hinterlands of Wolfsbane Hollow, Avud's curse took its full effect and he transformed under the light of the moon before his companions' very eyes. When the dust settled, Kreslik was the sole survivor of the encounter. Horrified by what he had done but intoxicated by the power of his newfound lycanthropy, Kreslik returned to Wolfsbane Hollow and spun a tale of noble self-sacrifice to the locals, martyring the inquisition. While the indigenous werewolves were indeed wiped out, Kreslik lived on in secret, spending days around the full moon far from civilisation in order to hide his secret. Kreslik, a member of the thieves' guild, used his newfound cunning and strength to work his way up through their ranks, eventually killing and supplanting their leader. Kreslik worked to control his power and under his leadership the thieves' guild were finally able to sink their talons into the mayor's office and wrest control of the town, from its complacent folk.

With the thieves' guild in control, Wolfsbane Hollow struggled against its weakened yoke of western control. Arvallis, having never fully recovered from their war with the orc hordes, was in no shape to fight a war of secession. Arvallis, now merely a city-state, did not fight the demand for independence and contact with the west has largely been indifferent and cold ever since. While Wolfsbane Hollow gained its independence, Avud Kreslik endeavoured to find a way to gain further control over his lycanthropy. To this end, Kreslik required ancient rituals of giant magic recovered from the ruins in the Vurdfell Spine by explorers and adventurers. These rituals, requiring the blood sacrifice of dozens of townsfolk over a span of seven years, ultimately drew too much attention.

Thirty-seven years ago, fearful of a resurgent werewolf plague, the locals of Wolfsbane Hollow again banded together to hunt down this creature of the night. Nicknamed the Redclaw Reaper by local rumourmongers, this werewolf menace was blamed for every ill the people of Wolfsbane Hollow endured. However, never did they discover the truth of this lycanthropic blight, for Kreslik had outmanoeuvred them. With his newfound ability to curse others with lycanthropy, Kreslik assaulted an enemy of the thieves' guild—the alchemist Alduir Weyrud—on the eve of a full moon. When Weyrud transformed the next night and rampaged through the town, Kreslik watched as the fanatical townspeople cornered the fledgling werewolf in the Cathedral of Ignis. Barring him inside they burned the building to the ground. After sending an innocent man to a fiery death, Kreslik resumed his role as the leader of the thieves' guild and the true power in Wolfsbane Hollow.

Kreslik has gradually built an inner circle of werewolves loyal to him, living in the shadows of Wolfsbane Hollow for the last sixty years. Kreslik helps his werewolf subordinates learn how to control their power and cages them during the full moon if they are unable to depart town.

Kreslik's feels his absolute control over Wolfsbane Hollow threatened as of late. Foreign merchants have brought renewed interest in the town as well as discussions of building a bridge across Deepshadow Gorge to open up trade with the east. This, coupled with the success of the remote mining community of Hjalward to the north, has brought the eye of Arvallis back to Wolfsbane Hollow, and along with that assiduous stare a clandestine group of lycanthrope hunters who are on the verge of discovering Kreslik's secret.



REGIONAL GAZETTEER

The region surrounding the town of Wolfsbane Hollow is wild and untamed; opportunities for adventure abound.

WOLFSBANE HINTERLANDS

The Wolfsbane Hinterlands are a swath of rugged, wild terrain spread over roughly 1,300 square miles south of Mount Middenvurd in the Vurdfell Spine.

The region was once a frontier holding of the remote, western empire of Arvallis, but when the empire collapsed, the region became self-governed. Now thousands of free-minded hunters, woodsmen, farmers and panhandlers flock to the region to live their lives without interference by government bodies.

Much of the Wolfsbane Hinterlands are not fully explored or contain long-abandoned Arvullan settlements. Only Wolfsbane Hollow stands as a bastion of civilisation in this rugged frontier. Other points of interest are detailed below.

ASHENBLADE FOREST

Located along the southwestern edge of the Vurdfell Spine, the Ashenblade Forest was once home to a clan of elves called the Tuinadin (roughly: ghost-faced people, in Common.)

While the southern edge of the forest is considered safe and is the primary logging site for the Wolfsbane Hollow lumber guild, rumours persist of mortal danger dwelling deeper in the ancient wood. These stories date back to the time of Arvallis' collapse, when the elves of the Ashenblade Forest disappeared without a trace, and explorers who ventured into the woods seeking the missing elves rarely returned. Those who did return spun terrifying tales of the forest coming alive to attack their companions, nightmarish undead riddled with vegetation and strange wailing noises in the dark. An occasional treasure hunter still ventures into these woods every decade or so, lured by promises of riches remaining in the abandoned elven town of Tuinadarael at the forest's heart. None have penetrated far enough into the forest to find whatever remains of the settlement.

DRUNAU FOREST

Comprised primarily of cedar, poplar and maple trees the Drunau Forest attracts lumber workers from nearby Wolfsbane Hollow. However the southern flow of the Valyn River means any lumber taken from the Drunau Forest must be hauled on barges against the current, making forestry in the region less appealing. Small human settlements, typically single-family homesteads or cabins, dot the forest's fringes.

DANKWOOD

This forest of red maple, spruce and hemlock bristles up from the eastern banks of the Valyn River. Primarily a peat swamp, rocky areas of higher and drier land spot the rolling hills and deep, watery recesses of the forest.

Dankwood's difficult terrain has left it largely untouched by the local forestry industry and the forest's inhabitants—a circle of

druids tracing their roots back more than 1,200 years—are content to be left alone. These druids do not actively participate in the goings-on in the region, though occasionally send scouts to the Ashenblade Forest. The druids of Dankwood know full well what happened long ago to the elven town of Tuinadarael and have chosen to keep that secret for centuries. Other than the druids, Dankwood is home to stirges, swamp giants, a small clan of trolls and will-o'-wisps.

GREAT ARVOLLAN FOREST

Spanning 1,100 miles between the border of Wolfsbane's Hinterlands and the eastern edge of the Arvullan city-state, the Great Arvullan Forest is huge. The eastern-most edge of the forest cutting into the Wolfsbane Hinterlands is primarily pine and oak with some cedar and birch. The forest terrain is rocky and hilly with large granite deposits dotting the woodland, including enormous free-standing boulders brought down from the Vurdfell Spine by a glacier over 10,000 years ago.

The Great Arvullan Forest is dotted with farmlands and cabins, the density of which grows thinner the further west one travels beyond the Hinterlands. Unknown thousands of wild beasts call this forest home, from simple stags and bears to majestic drakes and giant eagles. Much of the forest's western expanse is unexplored, enticing explorers into its ancient recesses.

THE EMPIRE OF ISGILTUR

Long before the rise of human kingdoms, the empire of Isgiltur rose to monolithic heights east of the Vurdenfell Spine. Born of the power of ancient giants, this kingdom now exists as little more than crumbling ruin and speculation. Legends claim all of Isgiltur was destroyed in a single night by a great magical calamity, though the veracity of that claim is hotly disputed by explorers who believe in a slower decline caused by disease and famine. Today, Isgiltur's gigantic ruins dot the land.

One surviving remnant of Isgiltur is the Hjalward, a colossal wall of stone following the Vurdfell Spine for nearly 200 miles, crossing over the crown of Mount Kalisford. It is an engineering marvel, sixty feet thick and 200 ft. tall, supported by flying buttresses. Every ten miles a 500 ft. tall watchtower, called an augan in Giant, rises from the wall. An iron brazier that—when filled with timber and lit—could be seen by adjacent augans crowned each tower, and served as a means of swift communication in times of crisis.

Today, one-third of the Hjalward stands at its full height and only nine of its 196 augan remain intact. Thirty-seven breaches rent the wall; some created by monstrous incursions, others by time itself. Most of the intact augan stand in remote portions of the Vurdfell Spine, serving as lairs for foul monsters and the like. Adventurers—unsurprisingly—often attempt expeditions to explore these augans. The savagely harsh terrain stymies many such expeditions and yet more adventurers fall before the might of the creatures claiming the augans as their own.

GREATSHADOW GORGE

At up to 6,000 feet deep, the Greatshadow Gorge is an impressively large natural barrier dividing the eastern edge of human civilisation with the western frontier of the orc Hordelands.

The gorge's northern tip cuts into the wintry expanse of tundra beyond the Vurdfell Spine, while its southern-most point lies 170 miles south of the Wolfsbane Hinterlands at the furthest edge of the Vurdfell Spine. The gorge's sheet rock walls are primarily granite and limestone with striations of marble, shale and slate.

The bottom of the gorge is a sparsely forested, rocky place known by humans and orcs alike as the Greatshadow Underwood. This dark forest comprises fir, basswood, hemlock and white cedar trees between which snakes a rapidly flowing river fed from meltwater originating at the northern end of the gorge. Called Blackwater by humans, this river is known as the Orlo-gutang (bitter springs) by the orcs living on the eastern side of the gorge's. The river's water is heavily tainted with sulphur, giving it an eggy aroma and bitter taste.

Neither human nor orc reside close to the Greatshadow Gorge; both societies fear open conflict with one another and have wisely settled no closer than ten miles from the border. Thus, the gorge itself is home only to wandering—or savage—shadow-loving monsters. Sometimes strange aberrations emerge from certain deep caves hidden under the Greatshadow Underwood's grey boughs. Adventurers often come here to battle such foul creatures; only skilled heroes survive.

VURDFELL SPINE

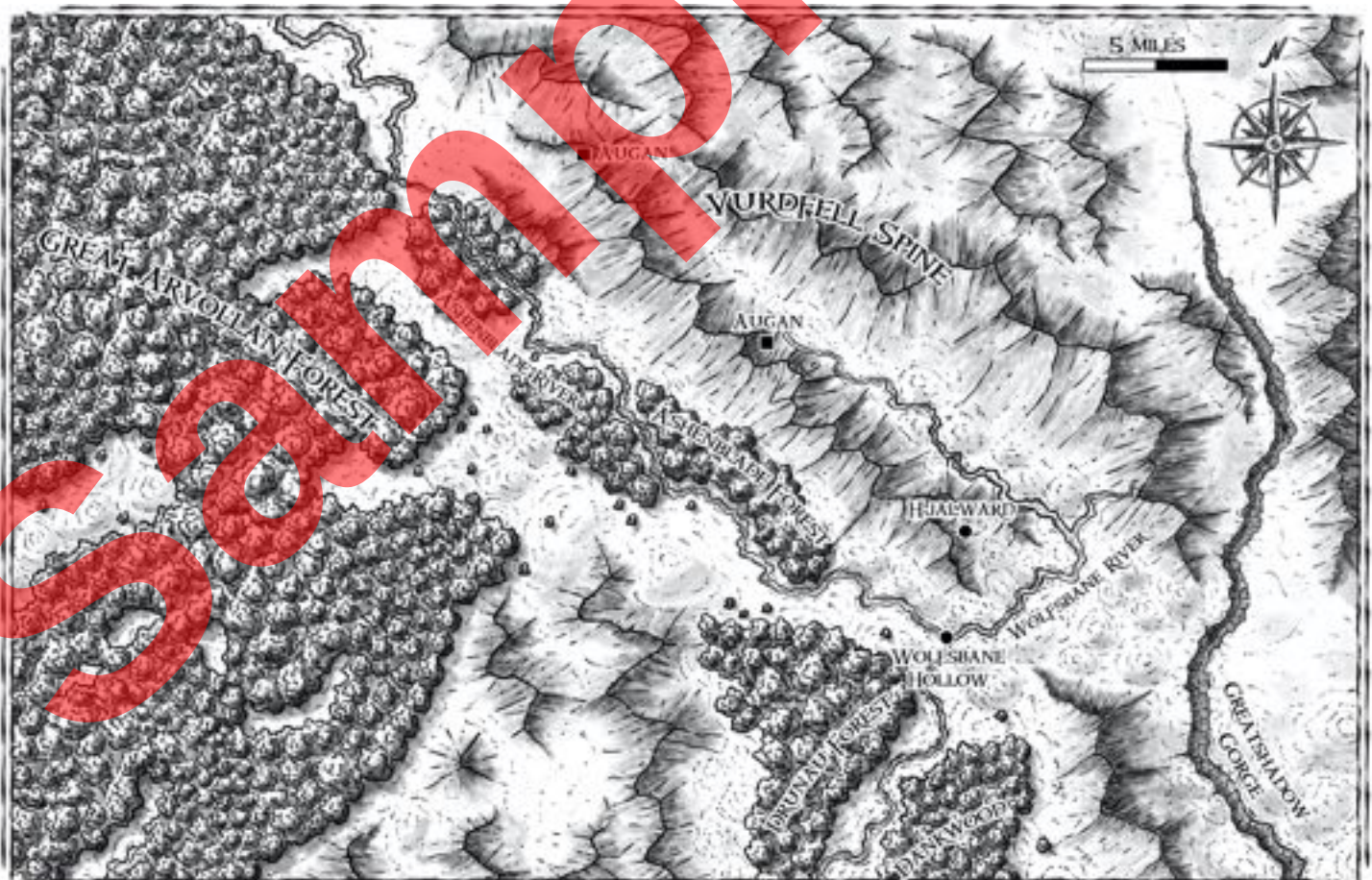
The Vurdfell Spine mountain range is a natural barrier to the Hordelands of the orcs to the east. The Spine runs for 2,500 miles and its highest peak juts nearly 28,000 feet into the sky. The range is mostly unsettled and populated by predatory dragons, giants and worse.

MOUNT KALISFORD

The highest peak of the Vurdfell Spine, Mount Kalisford is 27,850 feet tall. The Hjalward wall—an ancient construction from the long fallen giant empire of Isgiltur—cutting across the Vurdfell Spine crosses this peak, and with the added height of these ruins the mountain surpasses 28,000 feet. No explorer is ever known to have reached the ruin atop Kalisford's peak and survived to tell the tale. Its presence remains an enticing beacon for many would-be adventurers.

HJALWARD

The village of Hjalward, located on the southern slope of Mount Kalisford, is built atop snow-covered hills in the shadow of ancient giant-crafted architecture. Nearby deposits of iron, silver and lead draw desperate or avaricious miners to this cold village, while legends of lost giant treasure ensure a steady trickle of adventurers make the long, perilous journey.



WEATHER IN WOLFSBANE HOLLOW

Use these tables to determine the weather in Wolfsbane Hollow and its surrounds. These tables are not designed to be hyper-realistic; rather they provide the tools for you to describe the weather in generalities; the exact temperature, for example, is rarely of crucial importance.

To determine the weather on any given day:

- **Temperature:** Roll d20 and consult the relevant season table.
- **Weather:** Rolling d20 and consulting the relevant temperature column of the appropriate season table.
- **Precipitation Duration:** If precipitation is indicated determine its duration on the Weather Duration table.
- **Wind Direction:** Roll d20 on the Wind Direction table, but note the wind's direction may only be relevant if the characters are on the coast or aboard ship.
- **Wind Speed:** Roll d20 and consult the Wind Speed table.

WINTER

Winters are cold and harsh; snowfall is not uncommon and storms are common. During hard winters, trade and commerce shudder to a grinding halt as peasants huddle in their homes and great drifts of snow driven by the savage wind choke tracks and trails.

In particularly brutal winters, the town of Wolfsbane Hollow and village of Hjalward can quickly get cut off by gale-force winds and driving snow.

D20	FREEZING (1-13)	COLD (14-20)
1	Heavy fog	Heavy fog
2	Heavy fog	Light fog
3-5	Light fog	Clear sky
6-7	Clear sky	Light cloud
8	Light cloud	Light cloud
9	Light cloud	Light cloud, drizzle
10	Light cloud	Light cloud, rain
11	Overcast	Light cloud, rain
12	Overcast	Overcast
13	Overcast	Overcast, drizzle
14	Overcast, sleet storm	Overcast, rain
15	Overcast, hail storm	Overcast, rain
16	Light cloud, light snow	Overcast, hail storm
17	Light cloud, light snow	Overcast, sleet
18	Overcast, light snow	Overcast, sleet
19	Overcast, heavy snow	Overcast, sleet storm
20	Overcast, heavy snow	Overcast, sleet storm

SPRING

With spring comes a general thaw sets in and although fog often blankets low-lying hollows and valleys, the winds lessen and the temperature slowly rises. Rain is common and many trails degenerate into morasses of mud, making travel slow, miserable and costly.

D20	COLD (1-8)	COOL (9-20)
1	Heavy fog	Heavy fog
2	Heavy fog	Light fog
3-5	Light fog	Light fog
6-8	Clear sky	Clear sky
9-10	Light cloud	Light cloud
11	Light cloud, drizzle	Light cloud
12	Light cloud, drizzle	Light cloud, drizzle
13	Light cloud, rain	Light cloud, drizzle
14	Overcast	Light cloud, rain
15-17	Overcast	Overcast
18	Overcast, hail	Overcast, drizzle
19	Overcast, sleet	Overcast, drizzle
20	Overcast, light snow	Overcast, rain

SUMMER

In the summer months, the clouds clear, the winds quieten and the climate becomes markedly more pleasant, although few would describe the temperature as hot. The frequency and strength of rain also drops off, but sometimes dark clouds gather over the Vurdfell Spine—thunderstorms often result, and during this time old folk often mutter about the "Old One's Vengeance".

D20	WARM (1-13)	COOL (14-20)
1-3	Light fog	Light fog
4-8	Clear sky	Clear sky
9-11	Clear sky	Light cloud
12-13	Light cloud	Light cloud
14-15	Little cloud, drizzle	Light cloud, drizzle
16	Light cloud, rain	Light cloud, rain
17	Overcast	Light cloud, rain
18	Overcast, rain	Overcast
19	Overcast, rain	Overcast, rain
20	Thunderstorm	Overcast, rain

AUTUMN

As the temperature drops, the winds begin to gust with greater power, bringing winter's first harbingers—light snows, heavy frosts and freezing fog.

D20	COLD (1-9)	COOL (10-20)
1	Heavy fog	Heavy fog
2-3	Heavy fog	Light fog
4	Light fog	Light fog
5-6	Light fog	Clear sky
7	Clear sky	Clear sky
8-9	Clear sky	Light cloud
10	Light cloud	Light cloud
11-12	Light cloud	Light cloud, drizzle
13-14	Overcast	Light cloud, rain
15	Overcast, drizzle	Overcast
16	Overcast, rain	Overcast
17-18	Overcast, sleet ¹	Overcast, drizzle
19	Overcast, sleet storm ¹	Overcast, rain
20	Overcast, light snow ¹	Overcast, rain

1. The temperature drops to freezing

WEATHER DURATION

Precipitation falls on Wolfsbane Hollow all year round, though it is less common during the summer. In winter, snow is common.

WEATHER	DURATION ¹
Drizzle	1d10 hours
Hail storm	1d4 hours
Heavy fog	2d4 hours, then 1d4 hours of light fog
Heavy rain	1d12 hours
Heavy snow	4d6 hours
Light fog	2d4 hours
Light rain	1d12 hours
Light snow	2d6 hours
Sleet storm	1d6 hours
Thunderstorm	1d4 hours

1. If the maximum value of the die or dice is rolled, roll again and add the two results together to determine how long the precipitation lasts. Do not roll a third time.

WIND DIRECTION

Except in the winter, most wind comes from the south.

D20	SPRING	SUMMER	AUTUMN	WINTER
1-3	S	S	S	S
4	S	S	S	SW
5	SE	S	SE	SW
6	SE	S	SE	SE
7	SE	S	SE	SE
8	SW	SE	SW	SE
9	SW	SE	SW	E
10	SW	SE	SW	E
11	W	SW	W	E
12	W	SW	W	W
13	E	SW	E	W
14	E	W	E	NW
15	E	W	E	NW
16	NE	E	NE	NW
17	NW	E	NW	NE
18	NW	NW	NW	NE
19	NW	NE	NW	NE
20	N	N	N	N

WIND SPEED

In the winter, the wind howls about the Vurdfell Spine, dumping huge amounts of snow over the surrounding hills and forests.

D20	SPRING/ AUTUMN	SUMMER	WINTER
1-3	Light	Light	Light
4-5	Light	Light	Moderate
6	Moderate	Light	Moderate
7	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate
8-9	Moderate	Moderate	Strong
10	Moderate	Moderate	Strong
11	Moderate	Moderate	Strong
12	Strong	Moderate	Strong
13-16	Strong	Moderate	Severe
17-18	Severe	Moderate	Severe
19	Severe	Severe	Windstorm
20	Windstorm	Severe	Windstorm

RELIGION IN WOLFSBANE HOLLOW

The people of Wolfsbane Hollow worship the five deities of the Arvullan region, known collectively as the Circle. The deities of the Circle are animistic elemental entities tasked with the governance of broad societal concepts. Worship of the Circle, both individually and as a pantheon, dates back tens of thousands of years to the time of the giant empire of Isgiltur when the Circle stood as the giant's pantheon. The giants, in turn, imposed this worship on the "lesser races" they enslaved, and this worship survived beyond the fall of Isgiltur.

Today, worship of the Circle is prevalent across all peoples of the region, human and otherwise. Below is a brief synopsis of the five deities of the Circle and their role in the pantheon.

AETHER, THE BALANCE



Titles: The Arbiter, the Giver, the Taker, the Shrouded God

Adjective: Aetherite

Alignment: N

Portfolio: Afterlife, birth, death, family, knowledge, planar travel

Domains: Knowledge

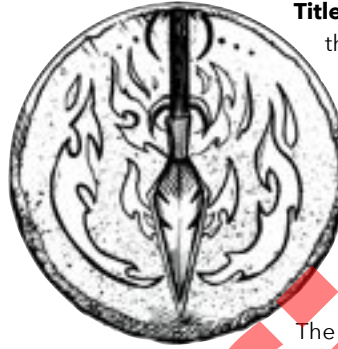
Favoured Weapon: Dagger

Symbol: A five-spoked wheel

The holy text of the Circle, called the Liturgy of Origin, speaks of the five deities of the Circle as the foundations of all creation. Their births signalled the beginning of the universe as we know it today and the end of the Age of Shapeless Forms; a time when unfathomable darkness and unspeakable horrors dominated the world. Aether is said to be the first god, neither alive nor dead, neither dead nor undead, existing in a state of "purgatorial bliss" somewhere within the Ethereal plane. Aether is depicted as a genderless ghost, always veiled, carrying a swaddled, skeletal child in its arms. In spite of Aether's genderless nature, priests still ascribe gender-specific pronouns to this deity; male when depicted as a taker of life, female when giving life.

The faithful of Aether see themselves as shepherds of life and death, acting as morticians, midwives, doctors and—sometimes—assassins. The most devout followers of Aether, known as the Dust Talkers, take a vow of silence with the living and only speak in the presence of the dead. Some Dust Talkers claim to have gained the supernatural gift to speak with the dead from this devotion. Other zealots of the faith believe they are entitled to the creation and subjugation of the undead as "gatekeepers" between the realm of living and dead. The Gatekeeper sect are seen as dangerous fanatics, at best.

IGNIS, THE FIRST SPARK



Titles: The Flame, the Even-Handed, the Purifier, the Pure

Adjective: Ignan

Alignment: NG

Portfolio: Civilisation, fire, healing, inspiration, hope, light

Domains: Knowledge, Light

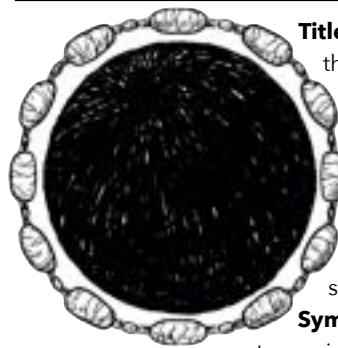
Favoured Weapon: Spear

Symbol: A flaming spear

The Canticle of Forging from the Liturgy of Origin speaks of Ignis as the first flame; a spark of creation that brought with her birth the first light that cast away the darkness of the Age of Shapeless Forms. Believed to be the second deity birthed into the new universe after Aether, Ignis is seen as a bringer of light and hope. While fire can be destructive, Ignan faithful see only uncontrolled or reckless use of fire dangerous. Ignan priests are healers of the sick, purifiers of the impure and crusaders against injustice and suffering. Ignis herself is depicted as a selfless and noble woman of indeterminate race, though sometimes an idealised member of a priest's own race. Ignis is also seen as the forbearer of civilisation, viewed as protector of cities and towns, and muse to creators and craftsmen alike.

Ignis' priests are renowned healers, even without the gift of magic. The Ignan faith trains physicians and surgeons, sending them on pilgrimages to cure disease and ease suffering wherever they can. More militant followers of Ignis interpret her will at the point of a spear, crusading against the horrors of the world: aberrations, demons, undead and their ilk. The Ignan faith has a zealous sect of inquisitors called the Pyre of Glory that root out subversive evils throughout the world, from shapeshifters, to vampires and all other manner of beast that can hide among men.

MARI, THE DEEP



Titles: The Claimer, the Drowned God, the Hungry, the Woken

Adjective: Maran

Alignment: NE

Portfolio: Drowning, darkness, evil, fear, seas, water

Domains: Nature, Tempest

Favoured Weapon: Unarmed strike

Symbol: A black sphere trimmed with turquoise

The last of the pantheon named in the Canticle of Secrets, Mari, was born from the lightless depths of the deepest oceans. Mari is the only member of the Circle to have an inhuman appearance, always depicted as some sort of amalgamation of aquatic creatures: equal parts squid, crustacean, fish, shark and worse. Mari, like Ventus, was not originally a venerated deity but a creature of nightmare that was awoken from the depths of the